

shakthi, and this is indicated in the owner and group fields. The '.' entry represents the current '/tmp/test' directory. The '..' listing represents the parent directory, which is '/tmp' and owned by the 'root' user.

Exit

You can exit from Dired mode by simply pressing *q* (quit-window) in the Dired buffer.

Navigation

You can move to a previous line or the next line in the Dired buffer using the *p* and *n* keys, respectively. If you wish to move the cursor to the previous and next directories, you can use the '<' and '>' keys. If the cursor is at 'kernel' directory as shown below...

```
/tmp/test:
total used in directory 24 available 146721468
drwxrwxr-x 4 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 3 11:36 .
drwxrwxrwt 12 root root 4096 Jul 3 11:38 ..
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 29 Jul 3 11:36 date.txt
drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 3 11:36 kernel <-- CURSOR
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 270 Jul 3 11:36 locale.txt
drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 3 11:36 network
```

...then, when you press '>', the cursor will move to 'network', which is the next directory in the buffer.

```
/tmp/test:
total used in directory 24 available 146721468
drwxrwxr-x 4 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 3 11:36 .
drwxrwxrwt 12 root root 4096 Jul 3 11:38 ..
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 29 Jul 3 11:36 date.txt
drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 3 11:36 kernel
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 270 Jul 3 11:36 locale.txt
drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 3 11:36 network
<-- CURSOR
```

You can move to the parent directory using the ^ key. To enter into a directory, move to its listing in the Dired buffer, and simply hit the *return* key.

Viewing files

To view a file, you can place the cursor on its entry and use the *f* or *v* key, or simply hit the *return* key. This will open the file in a new buffer (view). To return to the Dired buffer, you can type *C-x b* and the minibuffer will prompt you with the message 'Switch to buffer (...)'. If you then press *TAB*, it will open a new *Completions* buffer that will list the available buffers. You can also type the entire 'test' buffer name, or type it partially and hit *TAB* for auto-completion, and hit the return key to get to the 'test' buffer. If you wish to close a buffer, you can use *C-k* to kill it. This will only close the buffer, but the file will still exist! You can use the '+' key to create a new sub-directory.

Marking and unmarking files

Dired mode allows you to operate on multiple files and directories. In order to run commands on them, you need to first select the files. The *m* key can be used to mark a file or directory for subsequent operations. For example, pressing 'm' on the *date.txt* entry will mark it, and this is indicated by an asterisk in front of the line, as shown below:

```
/tmp/test:
total used in directory 24 available 146933380
drwxrwxr-x 4 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:53 .
drwxrwxrwt 10 root root 4096 Jul 5 09:46 ..
* -rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 29 Jul 5 09:46 date.txt
drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:46 kernel
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 270 Jul 5 09:46 locale.txt
drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:46 network
```

You can unmark the above selection using the *u* key. This is applicable for both files and directories. To undo a selection, you can also use *M-del* (M and the Delete key). Suppose, you wish to mark all the directories in the Dired buffer, you can use a '* /' key combination. The resultant Dired buffer is shown below:

```
/tmp/test:
total used in directory 24 available 146933432
drwxrwxr-x 4 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:53 .
drwxrwxrwt 10 root root 4096 Jul 5 09:46 ..
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 29 Jul 5 09:46 date.txt
* drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:46 kernel
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 270 Jul 5 09:46 locale.txt
* drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:46 network
```

If you want to invert the selection, use *t*. The buffer will look like the following:

```
/tmp/test:
total used in directory 24 available 146933432
drwxrwxr-x 4 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:53 .
drwxrwxrwt 10 root root 4096 Jul 5 09:46 ..
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 29 Jul 5 09:46 date.txt
drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:46 kernel
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 270 Jul 5 09:46 locale.txt
drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:46 network
```

To mark all the files, you can use the '* s' key combination.

Modifying the buffer

After you have selected files, you can remove them from the listing by pressing the *k* key. This does not delete the files! You can always press *g* to refresh the Dired buffer contents. You can change the *ls* command line options used in the Dired listing using the *C-u s* key combination.